



KBM Neurological Institute

PATIENT INFORMATION POLICY

Neurology Practice / Clinic: [Practice Name]

Effective Date: [Date]

Policy Review Date: [Date]

Version: 1.0

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Patient Information Policy is to establish how **[Practice Name]** collects, manages, uses, stores, protects, and discloses patient information.

As a neurology practice, we recognise that patient information, particularly medical and neurological information, is highly confidential and must be handled with the highest level of care.

This policy is intended to protect patient privacy while ensuring that authorised healthcare professionals have access to the information required to provide safe and effective care.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All patients of the practice
- Doctors and neurologists
- Nurses and clinical staff
- Administrative employees
- Practice management
- Temporary staff and contractors
- Third-party service providers who process patient information
- Electronic and paper-based patient records

It applies to information collected during consultations, appointments, referrals, diagnostic investigations, treatment, billing, communication, and other healthcare-related activities.

3. Patient Information

Patient information may include:

Personal Information

- Full name and surname
- Date of birth
- Identity or passport number
- Contact details
- Residential address
- Emergency contact details
- Medical aid information

Medical Information

- Medical history
- Neurological history
- Symptoms and diagnoses
- Medication and treatment history
- Allergies
- Clinical examination findings
- Consultation notes
- Laboratory results
- MRI and CT results
- EEG and other neurological investigations
- Specialist reports
- Referral letters
- Treatment plans
- Prescriptions
- Follow-up information

Administrative Information

- Appointment information
 - Billing information
 - Medical aid claims
 - Payment records
 - Correspondence
 - Communication records
-

4. Collection of Patient Information

Patient information will generally be collected directly from the patient.

Information may also be obtained from:

- Referring healthcare professionals
- Hospitals and clinics
- Laboratories
- Radiology providers
- Medical schemes
- Other healthcare professionals involved in the patient's care
- Parents, guardians, or legally authorised representatives

Information will only be collected for legitimate healthcare, administrative, legal, or regulatory purposes.

5. Accuracy of Patient Information

The practice will take reasonable steps to ensure that patient information is accurate, complete, and up to date.

Patients are encouraged to inform the practice of any changes to:

- Contact details
- Address
- Medical aid information
- Emergency contacts
- Medication
- Allergies
- Relevant medical conditions

Where inaccurate information is identified, reasonable steps will be taken to correct it.

6. Confidentiality

All patient information is confidential.

Employees, healthcare professionals, contractors, and other authorised individuals who have access to patient information are required to maintain confidentiality.

Patient information must not be accessed, discussed, copied, disclosed, or distributed unless there is a legitimate healthcare, administrative, legal, or authorised purpose.

Confidentiality obligations continue after an employee or healthcare professional leaves the practice.

7. Use of Patient Information

Patient information may be used for:

- Providing medical and neurological care
- Diagnosing and treating patients
- Monitoring treatment and recovery
- Coordinating healthcare
- Making referrals
- Communicating with patients
- Scheduling appointments
- Processing medical aid claims
- Billing and financial administration
- Maintaining medical records
- Meeting legal and regulatory requirements
- Quality assurance and practice administration
- Preventing fraud or abuse
- Protecting patient and public safety where legally permitted

Patient information will not be used for unrelated purposes without appropriate authorisation or a lawful basis.

8. Disclosure of Patient Information

Patient information may be disclosed to another person or organisation where:

- The patient has provided appropriate consent
- Disclosure is necessary for the patient's healthcare
- Disclosure is required by law
- Disclosure is required by a court or lawful authority
- Disclosure is necessary to protect the patient or another person where legally permitted
- Disclosure is necessary for legitimate healthcare administration

Where information is shared with another healthcare provider, only information reasonably necessary for the relevant purpose should be disclosed.

9. Patient Consent

Where consent is required, the practice will obtain appropriate consent before collecting, using, or disclosing patient information.

Patients have the right to ask questions about:

- What information is being collected
- Why the information is required
- How the information will be used
- Who may receive the information
- How the information will be protected

Consent may be recorded electronically, in writing, or through another appropriate method.

10. Access to Patient Records

Patients may request access to their personal and medical information, subject to applicable legal and professional requirements.

Requests should be submitted to:

Information Officer: [Name / Position]

Email: [Email Address]

Telephone: [Telephone Number]

The practice may require reasonable identification before releasing patient information.

Where legally permitted, reasonable administrative charges may apply for processing or reproducing records.

11. Correction of Information

Patients may request that inaccurate or incomplete information in their records be corrected.

Where appropriate, the practice will:

1. Verify the requested correction.
2. Update the relevant information.
3. Maintain an appropriate record of the amendment.
4. Inform relevant parties where necessary and legally permitted.

Clinical records should not be altered in a manner that removes or obscures the original clinical record.

12. Sharing Information with Family Members

Patient information will not automatically be disclosed to family members.

Information may be shared with a family member where:

- The patient has provided appropriate consent;
- The patient has authorised the person to receive information;
- The person is legally authorised to act on behalf of the patient; or
- Disclosure is otherwise permitted or required by law.

Patients should inform the practice if they wish to nominate someone to receive information on their behalf.

13. Minors and Legally Incapacitated Patients

Where the patient is a minor or is unable to provide informed consent, information will be managed in accordance with applicable law and the rights of parents, guardians, or legally authorised representatives.

The practice will take appropriate measures to protect the confidentiality and best interests of the patient.

14. Electronic Patient Records

Where electronic systems are used to store patient information, access will be restricted to authorised personnel.

Security measures may include:

- User authentication
- Password controls
- Role-based access
- Secure networks
- Encryption where appropriate
- Audit logs
- Data backups
- Security monitoring
- Access restrictions

Users must not share their system passwords or access credentials.

15. Paper Records

Paper-based patient records must be stored securely and protected from unauthorised access.

Patient records should not be:

- Left unattended in public areas
- Removed from the practice without authorisation
- Photographed or copied without permission
- Destroyed without following the approved records-retention process

16. Communication with Patients

The practice may communicate with patients through:

- Telephone
- Email
- SMS
- Appointment systems
- Secure electronic communication platforms
- Postal correspondence
- Other approved communication methods

Reasonable precautions will be taken when communicating confidential information electronically.

Patients should notify the practice if they have concerns about a particular communication method.

17. Patient Information Security

The practice will implement reasonable administrative, technical, and physical safeguards to protect patient information against:

- Unauthorised access
- Loss
- Theft
- Damage
- Unauthorised disclosure
- Accidental destruction
- Unlawful processing
- Unauthorised alteration

Any suspected privacy or security incident should be reported to the practice management or Information Officer as soon as possible.

18. Data Breaches

If the practice becomes aware of a security compromise involving patient information, the incident will be investigated and appropriate steps will be taken to contain and address the breach.

Where notification is required by applicable law, affected patients and relevant authorities will be notified in accordance with the applicable requirements.

19. Retention of Patient Records

Patient records will be retained in accordance with applicable South African legislation, healthcare requirements, professional standards, and the practice's records-retention procedures.

Records will be securely disposed of when the applicable retention period has expired.

Disposal methods must prevent unauthorised access to the information.

20. Third-Party Service Providers

The practice may use third-party providers for services such as:

- Practice management software
- Electronic medical records
- Cloud storage
- Appointment scheduling
- Billing
- Medical aid administration
- IT support
- Laboratory and diagnostic services

Where third parties process patient information on behalf of the practice, appropriate contractual and security safeguards should be implemented.

21. Patient Rights

Subject to applicable law, patients may have rights relating to their personal information, including the right to:

- Know what personal information is being processed
- Request access to their information
- Request correction of inaccurate information
- Object to certain processing
- Request deletion where legally permitted
- Withdraw consent where processing is based on consent
- Ask questions about the handling of their information
- Lodge a privacy complaint

These rights may be subject to legal, medical, regulatory, or other lawful limitations.

22. Complaints

Patients who have concerns about the handling of their information should first contact:

Information Officer: [Name]

Email: [Email Address]

Telephone: [Telephone Number]

The practice will investigate complaints and take reasonable steps to resolve legitimate concerns.

Patients may also have the right to approach the relevant South African regulatory authority where appropriate.

23. Staff Responsibilities

All staff members are responsible for protecting patient information.

Staff must:

- Only access information required for their duties
- Maintain confidentiality
- Keep passwords and access credentials secure
- Avoid discussing patient information in public areas
- Verify patient identity before releasing information
- Report suspected privacy breaches
- Follow the practice's information-security procedures
- Dispose of confidential information securely

Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary or other appropriate action.

24. Policy Review

This Patient Information Policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure that it remains consistent with:

- Applicable legislation
- Healthcare requirements
- Professional standards
- Changes in technology
- Changes in the practice's operations
- Patient privacy requirements

The practice reserves the right to amend this policy where necessary.

25. Patient Acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have been informed about how **[Practice Name]** collects, uses, stores, protects, and discloses my personal and medical information.

I understand that I may contact the practice if I have questions regarding the handling of my information or wish to exercise applicable privacy rights.

Patient Name: _____

Patient / Representative Signature: _____

Date: _____

Representative Name (if applicable): _____

Relationship / Authority: _____

Practice Information

Practice Name: [Neurology Practice Name]

Neurologist / Medical Practitioner: [Doctor Name]

Information Officer: [Name]

Telephone: [Telephone Number]

Email: [Email Address]

Physical Address: [Practice Address]

Policy Version: 1.0

Effective Date: [Date]

Next Review Date: [Date]